

To make the Finder forget about a temporarily ejected disk, drag the dimmed icon to the Trash (or select “Put Away” from the File menu). It’s not necessary to insert the disk before getting rid of the dimmed icon.

Working With 5.25” Disks

Because the Finder can’t tell when you remove and insert 5.25” disks., it displays both the drive *and* the disk as icons on the desktop. Anytime you remove a 5.25” disk and insert a new one, double-click the drive icon to tell the Finder that you’ve switched disks. The Finder considers the disk you took out temporarily ejected (showing a dimmed icon) and adds the new disk to the desktop. The Finder will ask you to insert the removed disk again if you try to do anything with it—just insert the disk and click the “OK” button (or press Return).

To permanently eject a 5.25” disk, click the disk’s icon and select “Put Away” from the File menu (or drag the icon to the Trash). Then insert the new disk and double-click the 5.25” drive icon. The old disk’s icon will be completely removed and the new disk’s icon will appear. (You can also do it in the reverse order—drag the dimmed icon to the Trash after the new disk appears on the desktop.) If you don’t want to put a new disk in the drive, just drag the disk’s icon to the Trash and remove the disk from the drive.

If you insert a blank disk in a 5.25” drive and double-click the 5.25” drive icon, the Finder will grind the drive for a while, then ask if you want to initialize the disk. (The same thing may happen if you double-click the icon when no disk is in the drive.) We’ve already discussed the Initialize dialog earlier in this chapter.

▲ By The Way...

The Finder automatically checks your 5.25” drives for disks when it starts up. If you don’t use 5.25” disks very frequently, the grinding sound your empty drive makes when the Finder tries to read it will eventually begin to annoy you. When it does, turn off the “When starting up, check 5.25” drives” check box in the Finder Preferences (accessed under the Special menu). The Finder will then display your 5.25” drive icons but won’t automatically display the disks in them. If you want to use a 5.25” disk, just insert it and double-click the drive icon.

⑥ New & Improved

The Finder preference for not looking at 5.25” drives unless you double-click them is a new (and welcome) feature of System 6.

Working With Hard Drives & CD-ROMs

As we mentioned earlier, your hard drive may be divided into multiple partitions, each with its own icon. The ProDOS format only supports drives 32 megabytes and smaller, so drives larger than 32 megabytes must be partitioned into two or more partitions, each smaller than 32 megabytes. To the IIGS, each partition is a separate disk, and you’ll manipulate them as if they really were separate, even though they’re all physically on the same drive.